PAGE 1: INSTRUCTIONS FOR YOU – DO NOT SEND THIS PAGE TO AGENCIES

SEO RFP template: request for proposal

Fill in pages 2–5 and send the same RFP to 3–5 SEO agencies. You will get proposals for the same scope of work, in the same layout, with answers to the same questions. Keep page 6 to yourself: it is the proposal scoring sheet.

How to write an SEO RFP in 7 steps

1. **Agree on the goal and budget internally**: what should change in 12 months and what you can spend monthly.
2. **Collect your baseline data** (part 3): Search Console clicks and GA4 leads for the last 12 months, migrations, your history with agencies. No data? Write "none" rather than guessing.
3. **Describe the scope of work** (part 5): mark each area "required", "optional" or "out of scope".
4. **Set your working requirements** (part 7): Google accounts owned by you, content rights, links stay, notice period, reports from your own data.
5. **Pick 10–12 questions for agencies** (part 8) and tick them in the "Ask" column.
6. **Define the proposal format, timeline and criteria** (parts 9–10). Set the weights before opening proposals.
7. **Send the identical RFP to 3–5 agencies**. Share answers to questions with everyone at once.

Before you send it: 6 rules

- **Set the goal in leads, not rankings.** Google says no one can guarantee a #1 ranking on Google. Ask what results the agency expects, in what timeframe and how it will measure them.
- **Read-only access before the proposal.** Add agencies to Search Console as restricted users and to GA4 with the Viewer role. Remove access for those you do not hire.
- **Accounts stay with your business.** Your business owns Search Console and GA4 (Administrator role). On your Google Business Profile, you are the primary owner and the agency is a manager.
- **Give a budget or a range.** Otherwise one agency prices the minimum, another a large scope, and you cannot compare them.
- **Allow 7–10 working days** for proposals, with an earlier deadline for questions and a decision date.
- **Compare prices as a 12-month cost**: monthly fee × 12 + one-off costs. Do not automatically pick the cheapest proposal: the scope usually differs.

Sample cover email

Subject: Request for proposal – SEO for [website]

Hello, we are looking for an agency to run SEO for our website [address] from [month]. Attached is our request for proposal with details of our business, goal, current site and scope of work. We are sending the same RFP to a few agencies. Please send any questions to this address by [date] and your proposal by [date]. We will invite shortlisted agencies to a call in the week of [date]. This request does not commit us to signing a contract.
Best regards, [name, role, phone]

This template is for private businesses that choose their own supplier. It is not a public-sector tender document or a template for grant-funded projects, and it is not legal advice: for a large contract, have a lawyer review it. A description of each part, an example and sources: www.ai-seo-company.pl/en/tools/seo-rfp-template

TO SEND TO AGENCIES

Request for proposal: search engine optimization (SEO)

Company		**Website**	
Date sent		**Proposal deadline**	

1. Company and contact

Industry and main services or products	
Company size and area served	
Contact person (name, role, email, phone)	
Who decides which agency to hire	

2. Goal

A business result, not a ranking. If you do not track leads yet, say so: setting up key events in GA4 will be the first task.

12-month business goal (one sentence)	
How we measure it today (GA4, CRM, phone calls)	
Current value (for example monthly leads from organic search)	
Target value, or "please propose one"	
What success looks like after 3 months	

3. Baseline

Data for the last 12 months. Missing data is information too: write "none".

CMS, number of pages, languages	
Non-brand clicks, last 12 months (Search Console)	
Monthly leads from organic search (GA4)	
Google Business Profile: primary category, number of reviews	
Migrations, redesigns, traffic drops (with dates)	
Previous SEO work: who, for how long, what they did	
Access for agencies before they quote	☐ Search Console (restricted user) ☐ GA4 (Viewer) ☐ no access

4. Market and competitors

Area served: cities, countries, languages	
Services or categories in order of importance	1. 2. 3.
3–5 competitors from Google results and Maps	
What sets our business apart	
How customers find us today	

5. Scope of work to price

For content and links, give a monthly number and describe what it means (for example the type and length of content, the kind of link sources).

Area	Required	Optional	Out of scope
SEO audit and fix plan	☐	☐	☐
Technical fixes (implemented, or recommendations for our developer)	☐	☐	☐
Service or category pages	☐	☐	☐
New content – number per month: _____	☐	☐	☐
Links – number per month and source types: _____	☐	☐	☐
Local SEO and Google Business Profile	☐	☐	☐
AI search visibility (ChatGPT, Google AI Overviews)	☐	☐	☐
Tracking: key events in GA4	☐	☐	☐
Monthly report and meeting	☐	☐	☐
Support for a migration or a new website	☐	☐	☐
Other: _____	☐	☐	☐

6. Our resources

Who approves changes and content, and how quickly	
Developer: in-house, external or none; hours per month	
Who writes or supplies content and photos	
Agency access to the CMS and hosting	☐ yes ☐ after we approve changes ☐ no

7. Working requirements

Tick the terms you expect. An agency that does not accept them should say so in its proposal.

- [ ] Search Console, GA4, Tag Manager, Business Profile and ad account owned by our business; the agency gets permissions.
- [ ] Copyright in content, photos and graphics transferred to us, as set out in the contract.
- [ ] Links earned during the engagement stay after it ends; link list included in reports.
- [ ] No paid links or other practices that break Google's spam policies.
- [ ] Site changes only after our approval; change log kept.
- [ ] Monthly report based on our own Search Console and GA4 data.

Expected notice period: _____

Other requirements: _____

8. Questions for agencies (answer in your proposal)

Please answer in writing the questions ticked in the "Ask" column.

Ask	Question
☐	1. What results do you expect in our case, in what timeframe, and how will you measure them?
☐	2. What will you do in the first three months, and in what order?
☐	3. Who exactly will work on our site, and how will we communicate?
☐	4. Can you show us a sample report or a demo of your client portal?
☐	5. What experience do you have in our industry and our market (city, country, languages)?
☐	6. Do you follow Google Search Essentials, and where do your links come from?
☐	7. Will we approve site changes before release, and will we get a list of every change?
☐	8. How do you measure visibility in ChatGPT and Google AI Overviews?
☐	9. What exactly does the fee cover: how many keywords, pieces of content, links or hours a month?
☐	10. How long is the contract, what is the notice period, and are there exit fees?
☐	11. What happens if there is no progress after three months?
☐	12. Can we speak to a current or former client?
☐	13. Our own question:

9. Proposal and pricing format (completed by the agency)

Monthly fee excluding VAT	
One-off costs (audit, implementation, setup fee)	
What the fee covers: keywords, content, links, hours per month	
Billing model: retainer, pay for results, mixed	
Contract term and notice period	
Plan for the first 3 months	
Account lead and how to reach them	
Sample report or portal demo	☐ attached ☐ link: _____

Proposal format: PDF, up to _____ A4 pages, valid for at least _____ days.

10. Timeline and selection

Stage	Deadline
Questions from agencies	by
Answers shared with all agencies	by
Proposal deadline	by
Calls with shortlisted agencies	
Decision and reply to every agency	by

Scoring criterion	Weight
Understanding of the goal and a 3-month plan	%
Scope and what the fee covers	%
Tracking and reporting	%
Contract terms and ownership (accounts, content, links)	%
Team, experience and references	%
AI search visibility and Google compliance	%
Total	**100%**

Terms. This request does not commit the company to accepting any proposal or signing a contract, and it is not a tender. The information in it is confidential and may be used only to prepare a proposal. Several agencies receive the same request; answers to questions are shared with all of them at the same time.

INTERNAL USE ONLY – DO NOT SEND TO AGENCIES

Proposal scoring sheet

Scale: 0 – no answer or a generic one, 1 – partial answer, 2 – specific answer backed by evidence (a report, an example, a contract clause). Points per criterion = weight × score. Change the suggested weights (grey) before you open the proposals, not after.

Criterion	Suggested weight	Your weight	Agency A score / points	Agency B score / points	Agency C score / points
Understanding of the goal and a 3-month plan	25%				
Scope and what the fee covers	20%				
Tracking and reporting	15%				
Contract terms and ownership	15%				
Team, experience and references	15%				
AI search visibility and Google compliance	10%				
Score (sum of points)	**100%**				
12-month cost (12 × monthly fee + one-off costs)					

Red flags in proposals

Tick if present	A	B	C
A guaranteed #1 ranking, or rankings within a short time	☐	☐	☐
The same package for everyone, nothing about our site or goal	☐	☐	☐
"Full-service SEO" with no number of content pieces, links or hours	☐	☐	☐
Rankings from the agency's tool only, no data from our Search Console and GA4	☐	☐	☐
Google accounts set up under the agency, links "rented" for the duration of the contract	☐	☐	☐
A long contract with automatic renewal, or exit fees	☐	☐	☐
Promised "ChatGPT recommendations" with no measurement method	☐	☐	☐

Call notes

A	
B	
C	

Chosen agency: _____ Decision date: _____

AI SIGNALS COMPANY P.S.A., ul. Grzybowska 12/14 lok. B-3, 00-132 Warsaw, Poland